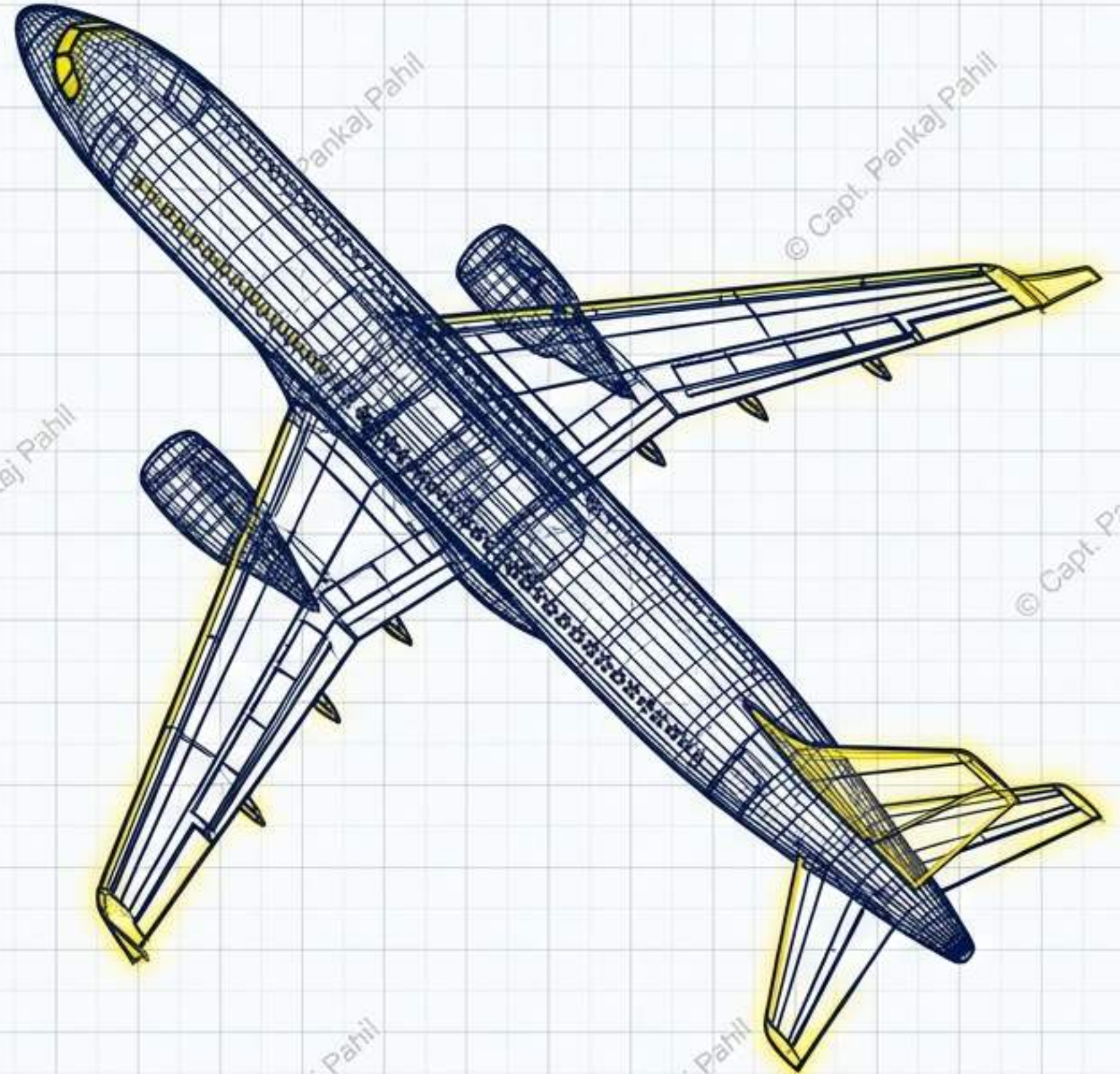


Aircraft Nationality & Registration Marks

Visual Master Guide:
Annex 7 & CAR Sec 2
Series F Part I

Designed for DGCA Examination Precision



Triad Node Diagram

International Telecommunication Union (ITU)

Allots foundational nationality symbols via radio call signs.

(e.g., symbols 4YA to 4YZ for common marks)

International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO)

Sets global standards (Annex 7) for the use and location of letters, numbers, and graphic symbols on airborne vehicles.

State of Registry (e.g., India/DGCA)

Assigns the final specific 1 to 5 digit/character registration marks to the individual aircraft.

India's ITU Allotment: AT to AW

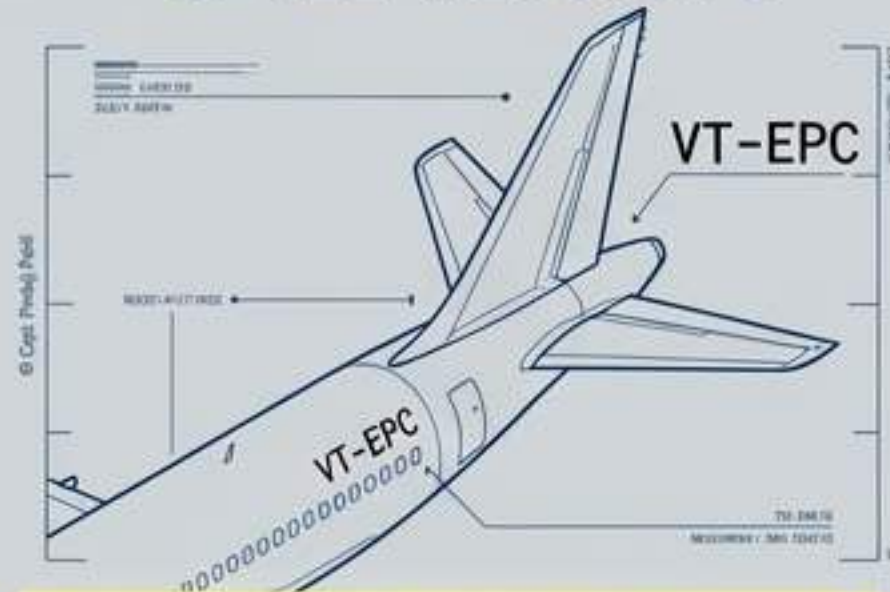
(Note: India continues to use pre-independence marks)

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License Plate Decoder

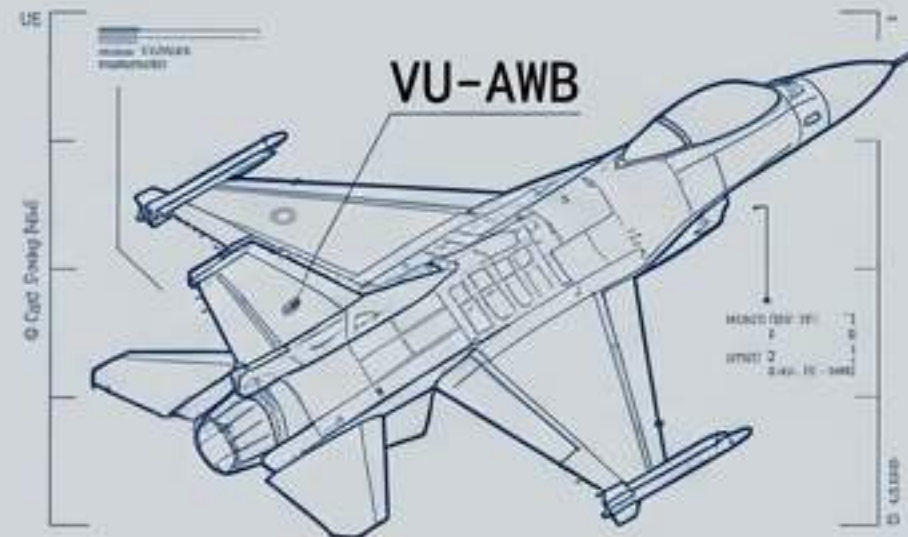
Civil Aircraft



VT

VT + Hyphen +
+ 3 Roman letters
(e.g., VT-EPC)

Military/Air-Force



VU

VU + Hyphen +
+ 3 Roman letters
(e.g., VU-AWB)

Unmanned/Drones



U

U + 6 Alpha-Numeric
characters (0-9, A-Z)
(e.g., UB67DFC)



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PROHIBITED MARK COMBINATIONS

Registration marks **MUST NOT** be confused with global safety and communication protocols.

5-LETTER COMBINATIONS

Used in the International Code of Signals.

3-LETTER COMBINATIONS

Beginning with Q
(used in the Q Code).

DISTRESS SIGNALS

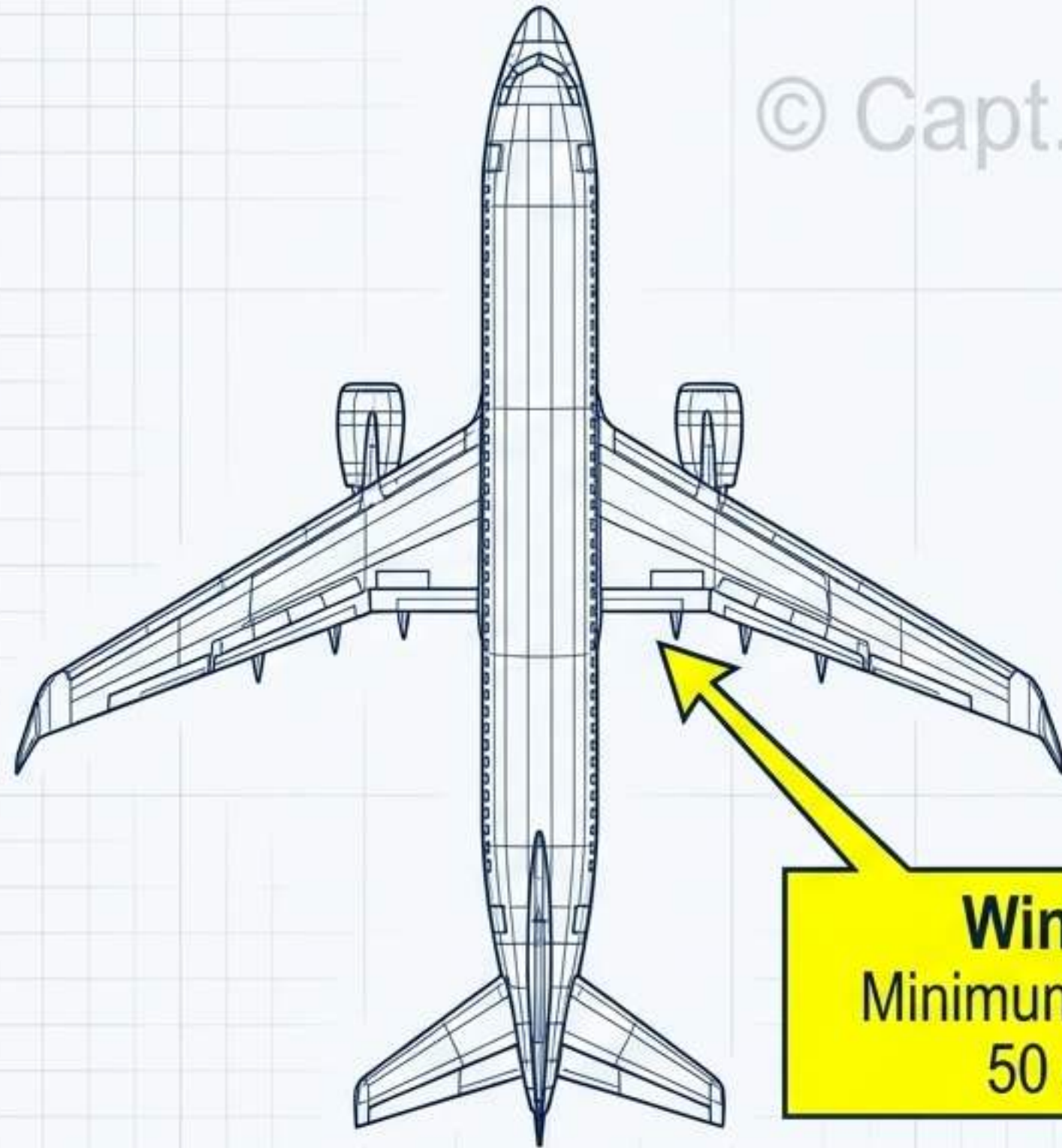
Specifically SOS.

URGENT SIGNALS

Explicitly including
XXX, PAN, and TTT.

Mark Measurements: Heavier-Than-Air

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Wings:
Minimum Height
50 cm



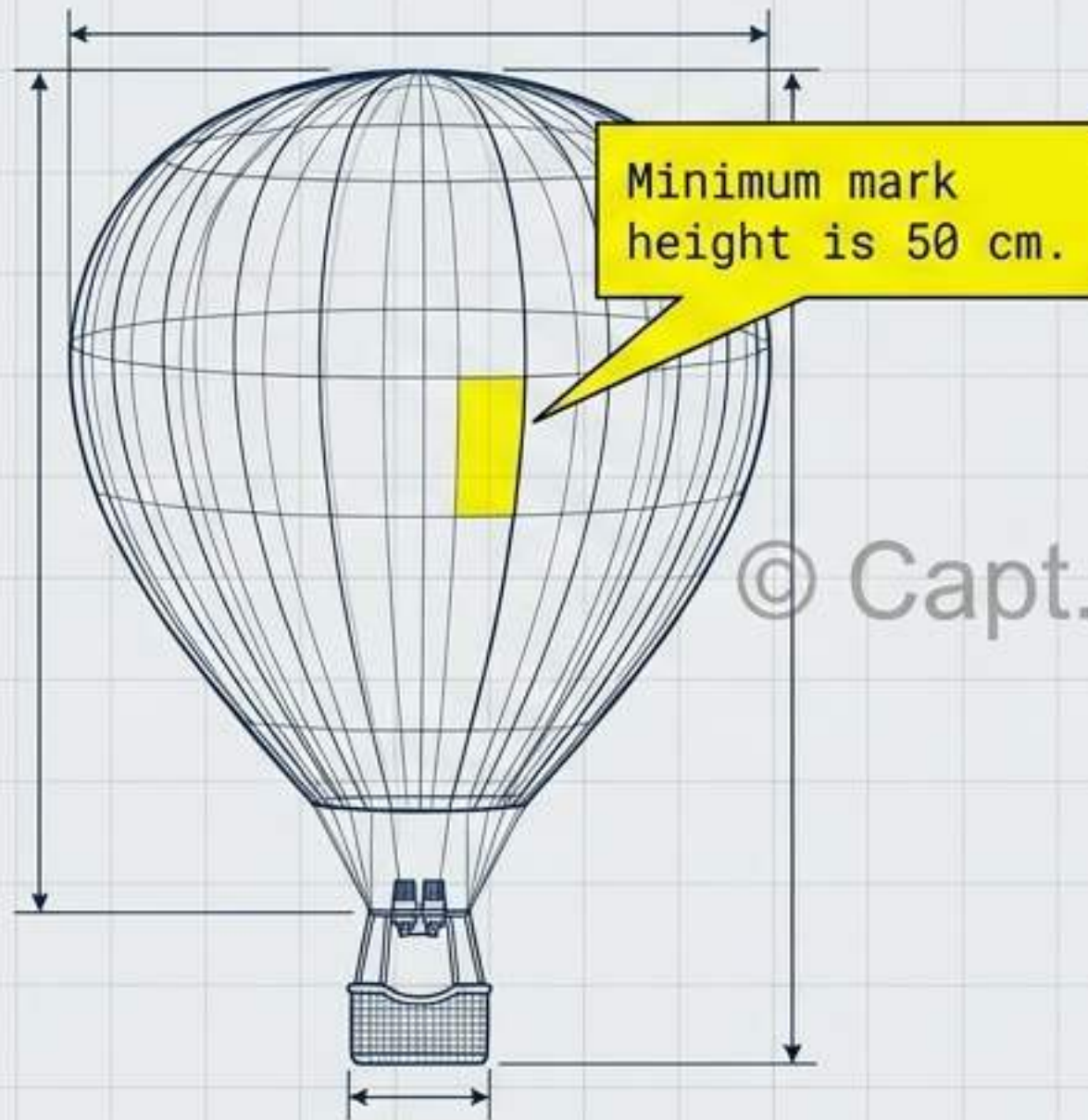
Fuselage:
Minimum Height 30 cm

Vertical Tail:
Minimum Height 30 cm

Vertical Tail:
Minimum Height
30 cm

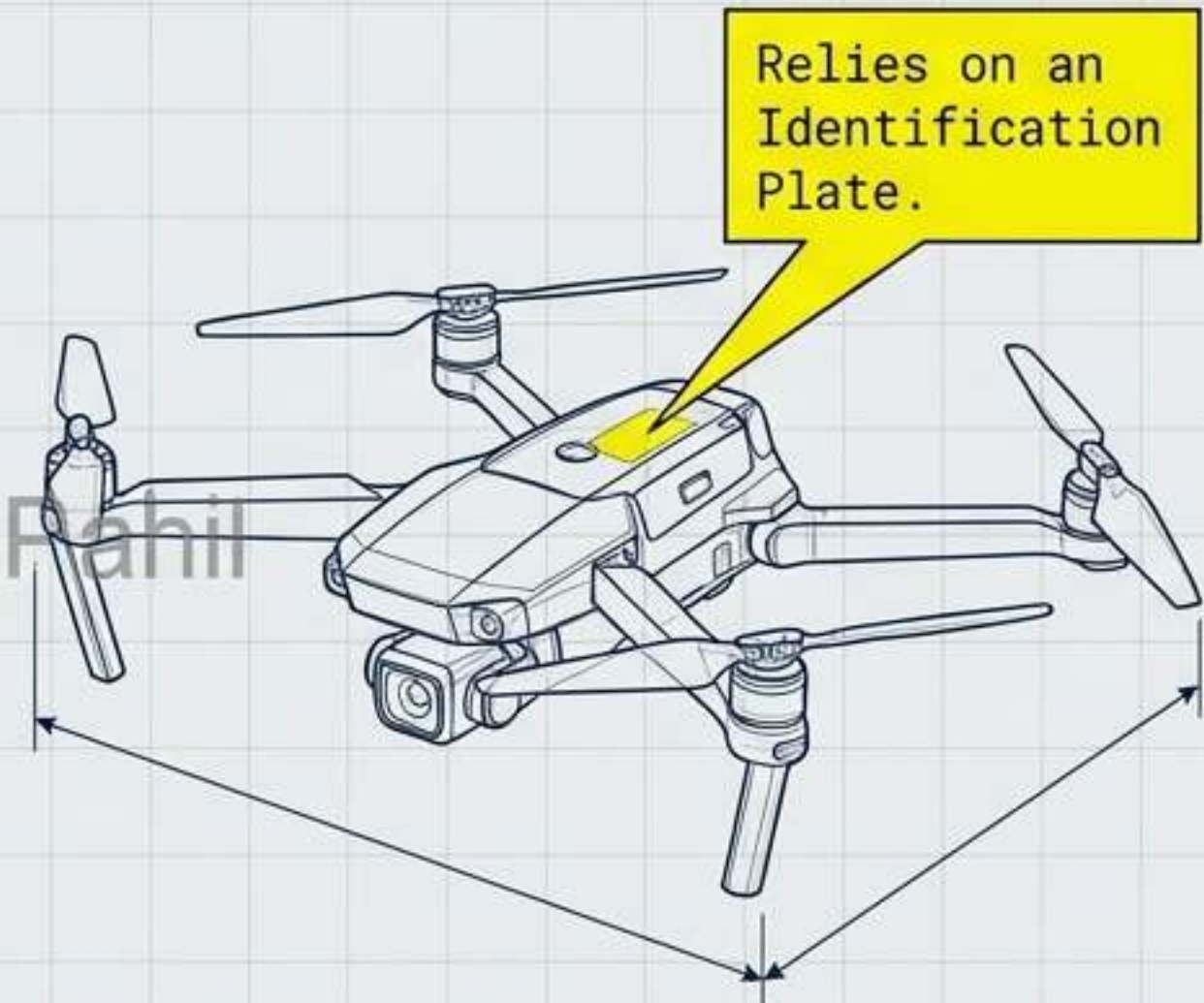
Design Constraint: Letters and numbers in each separate group of marks must be of equal height.

Lighter-than-Air Aircraft



Exception: Excludes unmanned free balloons. Measurements for unmanned free balloons are determined by the State of Registry based on payload size.

Remotely Piloted / Drones



Secured in a prominent position near the main entrance/compartments, OR affixed conspicuously to the exterior if no main entrance exists.



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MUST BE MADE OF
FIREPROOF
METAL/MATERIAL.

MUST BE INSCRIBED
WITH NATIONALITY +
REGISTRATION MARK.

MUST BE PLACED
PROMINENTLY NEAR THE
MAIN ENTRANCE.

EXTERIOR MARKING RULES

DON'T: DISPLAY ADVERTISEMENTS/SIGNS
UNLESS EXPLICITLY PERMITTED BY
THE DIRECTOR-GENERAL.

DON'T: BEAR MARKS PRESCRIBED FOR
STATE AIRCRAFT (IF A NON-STATE
AIRCRAFT).

DO: DISPLAY OWNER'S NAME/EMBLEM
(IF LOCATION, SIZE, SHAPE, AND
COLOR DON'T CAUSE CONFUSION WITH
REGISTRATION MARKS).

DO: DISPLAY NATIONAL FLAGS/COLORS
(IF DISTINCT AND NOT LIKELY TO
CAUSE CONFUSION WITH MILITARY
MARKINGS).

THE CERTIFICATE OF REGISTRATION (C OF R)

Issued by the Central Government. Must be carried in the aircraft at all times.

✓	Type of aircraft & Year of manufacture.
✓	Constructor's number.
✓	Nationality & Registration marks.
✓	Full name, nationality, and address of the owner.
✓	Usual station of the aircraft.
✓	Date of registration and period of validity.

THE LEASE ADD-ON

If leased, the C of R MUST also include:

Validity of the lease + names, nationalities, and addresses of the lessor and lessee.

Registration is not in conformity with the rules.

Registration was obtained by furnishing false information.

Aircraft could more suitably be registered in another country.

Aircraft has been destroyed or permanently withdrawn from use.

It is inexpedient in the public interest to remain registered in India.

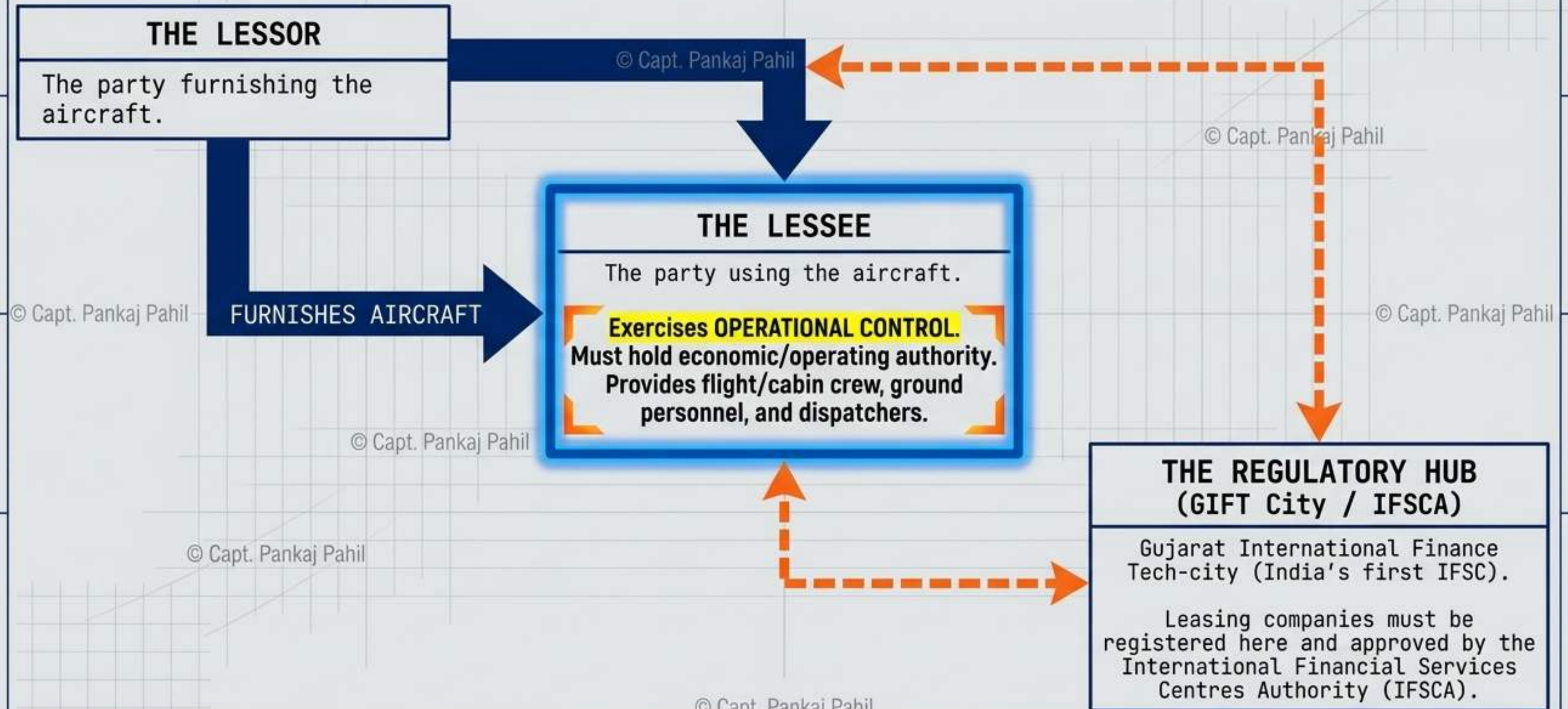
The lease has expired, been mutually terminated, or terminated per terms.

Certificate of Airworthiness has expired for a period of 5 years or more.

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**CANCELLATION
BY DGCA**

OPERATIONAL CONTROL RELATIONSHIP MAP



DGCA Exam Knowledge Synthesis

Exam Matrix	
The Trigger	The Exam Answer
Who assigns specific registration marks?	State of Registry
Who allots common mark symbols to ICAO?	ITU
What urgent signals are strictly banned?	XXX, PAN, TTT, SOS
Minimum mark height on wings?	50 cm
Minimum mark height on fuselage/tail?	30 cm
C of R validity period?	Valid until cancelled by DGCA
India's ITU allotted symbols?	AT to AW
India's actually used civil/military marks?	VT, VU, and U
Who exercises operational control of a lease?	The Lessee
Who approves leasing companies in India?	IFSCA